

Absolutely — **barrier** is a strong polysemy target because your passage uses it here:

> “Second, battery charging remains the greatest practical **barrier**.”

Here **barrier** means **something that prevents, delays, or makes an action difficult**, specifically an obstacle to wider adoption of electric vehicles.

Word family: **barrier / barrier-free**

Base noun: barrier

Adjective compound: barrier-free

Part of speech: noun (名詞)

Major domains:

- * physical obstacle / fence
- * road and crowd control
- * figurative obstacle
- * social/economic barriers
- * trade barriers
- * entry barriers
- * communication/language barriers
- * medical/biological barriers
- * technical/safety barriers
- * psychological barriers
- * legal/institutional barriers

Meaning in your passage: **barrier = obstacle that makes adoption difficult — 障礙 ; 阻力**

Your sentence:

> “battery charging remains the greatest practical **barrier**”

means:

> **charging is still the biggest practical obstacle preventing or discouraging people from using electric vehicles.**

繁體中文 :

妨礙某事發生、令某事更難進行的因素 ; 障礙 / 阻力

Natural translation:

> 「其次，電池充電仍然是最大的實際**障礙**。」

More natural in context:

> 「其次，充電問題仍然是電動車普及最大的實際**障礙**。」

So here:

> **barrier = 不是實體牆，而是阻礙採用電動車的實際困難**

A. PHYSICAL BARRIER

1. **barrier = physical object that blocks movement/access — 屏障；障礙物；阻隔物**

The original concrete sense.

Practice 1

> “A metal **barrier** blocked the road.”

「一道金屬**路障**封住道路。」

Practice 2

> “The fence forms a barrier between the two properties.”

「圍欄在兩個物業之間形成一道**屏障**。」

****barrier = 用來阻止人、車、動物或其他東西通過的實體物件****

B. ROAD BARRIER

2. **road barrier = 路障；道路護欄**

Practice 3

> “Police placed barriers across the road.”

「警方在道路上設置**路障**。」

Practice 4

> “The car hit the safety barrier.”

「汽車撞上了**安全護欄**。」

C. SAFETY BARRIER

3. **safety barrier = 安全屏障；防護欄**

Practice 5

> “The platform has a safety barrier.”

「月台設有**安全護欄**。」

Practice 6

> “Safety barriers prevent people from entering dangerous areas.”

「安全屏障可防止人進入危險區域。」

D. CRASH BARRIER

4. **crash barrier = 防撞欄；道路護欄**

Especially BrE.

Practice 7

> “The vehicle struck the crash barrier.”

「車輛撞上了**防撞欄**。」

Practice 8

> “Crash barriers reduce the risk of vehicles leaving the road.”

「防撞欄可降低車輛衝出道路的風險。」

E. CROWD BARRIER

5. **crowd barrier = 人群隔離欄；圍欄**

Practice 9

> “Crowd barriers were placed around the stage.”

「舞台周圍設置了**人群隔離欄**。」

Practice 10

> “Security staff stood behind the barriers.”

「保安站在隔離欄後面。」

F. BARRIER = FIGURATIVE OBSTACLE

6. **barrier = something that prevents or makes progress difficult — 障礙；阻礙因素**

This is your exact source sense.

Practice 11

> “High prices are a major **barrier** to adoption.”

「高價格是普及的一大**障礙**。」

Practice 12

> “Lack of trust can become a barrier to change.”

「缺乏信任可以成為改變的**阻力**。」

barrier — figurative = 令某事難以發生、推進或普及的因素

G. BARRIER TO + NOUN

7. **barrier to + noun =的障礙**

Practice 13

> “Cost is a barrier to ownership.”

「成本是擁有汽車的一個**障礙**。」

Practice 14

> “Poor infrastructure is a barrier to growth.”

「基建不足是增長的**障礙**。」

This is one of the most important constructions.

H. BARRIER TO + -ING

8. **barrier to + -ing = 做.....的障礙**

Practice 15

> “Charging time is a barrier to switching to electric cars.”

「充電時間是轉用電動車的一個**障礙**。」

Practice 16

> “Cost can be a barrier to entering the market.”

「成本可能成為進入市場的**障礙**。」

Important grammar:

> **to** here is a preposition

> so use:

> **to + noun / -ing**

not infinitive.

I. REMOVE A BARRIER

9. **remove a barrier = 消除障礙**

This connects directly to your previous word **remove**.

Practice 17

> “More chargers could remove a major barrier.”

「增加充電器可以**消除一項主要障礙**。」

Practice 18

> “The reform removed barriers to participation.”

「改革**消除了參與方面的障礙**。」

J. OVERCOME A BARRIER

10. **overcome a barrier = 克服障礙**

Practice 19

> “Better financing can help buyers overcome cost barriers.”

「更好的融資可以幫助買家**克服成本障礙**。」

Practice 20

> “Education can help overcome social barriers.”

「教育可以幫助**克服社會障礙**。」

K. BREAK DOWN BARRIERS

11. **break down barriers = 打破障礙；消除隔閡**

A common figurative expression.

Practice 21

> “Technology can help break down communication barriers.”

「科技可以幫助**打破溝通障礙**。」

Practice 22

> “The programme aims to break down social barriers.”

「這項計劃旨在****打破社會隔閡 / 障礙****。」

L. CREATE / RAISE A BARRIER

12. ****create/raise a barrier = 製造 / 設置障礙****

Practice 23

> “Complex rules create barriers for small firms.”

「複雜規則為小企業****製造障礙****。」

Practice 24

> “High fees raise a barrier to participation.”

「高昂費用形成了參與上的****障礙****。」

M. PRACTICAL BARRIER

13. ****practical barrier = 實際障礙****

Your exact phrase.

Practice 25

> “Charging access is a practical barrier.”

「充電設施不足是一項****實際障礙****。」

Practice 26

> “The problem is practical rather than ideological.”

「這個問題是****實際層面的障礙****，而不是理念問題。」

****practical barrier = 在日常執行、操作、時間、成本、設施等方面造成困難的障礙****

N. FINANCIAL BARRIER

14. **financial barrier = 財務障礙；經濟門檻**

Practice 27

> “The high purchase price creates a financial barrier.”

「高昂購買價形成了**財務障礙**。」

Practice 28

> “Subsidies can reduce financial barriers.”

「補貼可以降低**經濟門檻**。」

O. COST BARRIER

15. **cost barrier = 成本障礙；價格門檻**

Practice 29

> “Battery prices remain a cost barrier.”

「電池價格仍然構成**成本障礙**。」

Practice 30

> “Lower manufacturing costs could reduce the cost barrier.”

「較低製造成本可以降低**價格門檻**。」

P. SOCIAL BARRIER

16. **social barrier = 社會障礙；社會隔閡**

Practice 31

> “Education can reduce social barriers.”

「教育可以減少**社會障礙**。」

Practice 32

> “Class differences created social barriers.”

「階級差異造成了**社會隔閡**。」

This can mean:

- * obstacle to participation
- * separation between groups

Q. CULTURAL BARRIER

17. **cultural barrier = 文化障礙**

Practice 33

> “Different expectations can create cultural barriers.”

「不同的期望可能造成**文化障礙**。」

Practice 34

> “Training helps staff deal with cultural barriers.”

「培訓有助員工處理**文化差異造成的障礙**。」

R. LANGUAGE BARRIER

18. **language barrier = 語言障礙**

A very common fixed expression.

Practice 35

> “The **language barrier** made communication difficult.”

「**語言障礙**令溝通變得困難。」

Practice 36

> “Translation services can reduce language barriers.”

「翻譯服務可以減少語言障礙。」

S. COMMUNICATION BARRIER

19. **communication barrier = 溝通障礙**

Practice 37

> “Poor internet access can become a communication barrier.”

「網絡接入不足可以成為**溝通障礙**。」

Practice 38

> “Clear language helps remove communication barriers.”

「清晰語言有助消除溝通障礙。」

T. PSYCHOLOGICAL BARRIER

20. **psychological barrier = 心理障礙；心理阻力**

Practice 39

> “Fear can become a psychological barrier.”

「恐懼可以成為一種**心理障礙**。」

Practice 40

> “Lack of confidence creates psychological barriers to change.”

「缺乏信心會形成改變上的**心理阻力**。」

This need not imply a mental disorder.

It often simply means:

> mindset preventing action.

U. EMOTIONAL BARRIER

21. **emotional barrier = 情感障礙；心理隔閡**

Practice 41

> “Past experiences created an emotional barrier.”

「過去經歷造成了**心理隔閡**。」

Practice 42

> “Trust can help break down emotional barriers.”

「信任可以幫助打破**情感上的隔閡**。」

V. BARRIER BETWEEN PEOPLE

22. **barrier between people/groups = 人與人 / 群體之間的隔閡**

Practice 43

> “Status became a barrier between them.”

「地位差異成為他們之間的**隔閡**。」

Practice 44

> “Shared experiences helped remove the barrier between the groups.”

「共同經歷有助消除兩個群體之間的**隔閡**。」

This is less about “preventing action” and more about:

> separation / lack of connection.

W. TRADE BARRIER

23. **trade barrier = 貿易壁壘；貿易障礙**

A major economics sense.

Practice 45

> “Tariffs can act as trade barriers.”

「關稅可以形成**貿易壁壘**。」

Practice 46

> “The agreement aims to reduce trade barriers.”

「協議旨在減少**貿易障礙**。」

trade barrier = 限制跨境商品 / 服務交易的措施

Examples:

- * tariffs
- * quotas
- * restrictions
- * regulatory requirements

X. TARIFF BARRIER

24. **tariff barrier = 關稅壁壘**

Practice 47

> “The country reduced tariff barriers.”

「該國降低了**關稅壁壘**。」

Practice 48

> “Tariff barriers make imported goods more expensive.”

「關稅壁壘令進口商品更昂貴。」

Y. NON-TARIFF BARRIER

25. **non-tariff barrier = 非關稅壁壘**

Practice 49

> “Technical regulations can become non-tariff barriers.”

「技術規例可能成為**非關稅壁壘**。」

Practice 50

> “The negotiations covered tariffs and non-tariff barriers.”

「談判涵蓋關稅和**非關稅壁壘**。」

Z. BARRIER TO ENTRY

26. **barrier to entry = 進入障礙；市場進入門檻**

A major business/economics term.

Practice 51

> “High start-up costs are a barrier to entry.”

「高創業成本是市場**進入障礙**。」

Practice 52

> “Patents can create barriers to entry.”

「專利可能形成**市場進入壁壘**。」

barrier to entry = 令新競爭者難以進入市場的因素

AA. ENTRY BARRIER

27. **entry barrier = 進入壁壘**

Practice 53

> “The industry has high entry barriers.”

「這個行業有很高的**進入門檻**。」

Practice 54

> “Lower entry barriers can increase competition.”

「較低的市場進入障礙可以增加競爭。」

AB. BARRIER TO EXIT

28. **barrier to exit = 退出障礙**

Economics/business.

Practice 55

> “Long-term contracts can create barriers to exit.”

「長期合約可能形成**退出障礙**。」

Practice 56

> “High exit barriers can keep weak firms in the market.”

「高退出門檻可能令表現較差的企業仍留在市場。」

AC. REGULATORY BARRIER

29. **regulatory barrier = 監管障礙**

Practice 57

> “Complex approval procedures create regulatory barriers.”

「複雜審批程序形成**監管障礙**。」

Practice 58

> “The reform reduced regulatory barriers.”

「改革降低了**監管門檻**。」

AD. LEGAL BARRIER

30. **legal barrier = 法律障礙**

Practice 59

> “The proposal faces several legal barriers.”

「這項提議面對幾項**法律障礙**。」

Practice 60

> “A change in the law removed the barrier.”

「法律修改後，該項障礙被消除。」

AE. ADMINISTRATIVE BARRIER

31. **administrative barrier = 行政障礙；行政門檻**

Practice 61

> “Too much paperwork creates administrative barriers.”

「過多文書程序造成**行政障礙**。」

Practice 62

> “Digital applications can reduce administrative barriers.”

「電子申請可以降低行政門檻。」

AF. TECHNICAL BARRIER

32. **technical barrier = 技術障礙**

Practice 63

> “Battery performance remains a technical barrier.”

「電池性能仍然是一項**技術障礙**。」

Practice 64

> “Engineers solved several technical barriers.”

「工程師克服了幾項**技術障礙**。」

AG. TECHNOLOGICAL BARRIER

33. **technological barrier = 科技障礙；技術限制**

Practice 65

> “Limited battery capacity was once a technological barrier.”

「有限電池容量曾經是重要的**技術障礙**。」

Practice 66

> “Innovation can overcome technological barriers.”

「創新可以克服科技障礙。」

AH. INFRASTRUCTURE BARRIER

34. **infrastructure barrier = 基建障礙**

Practice 67

> “A lack of chargers is an infrastructure barrier.”

「缺乏充電器是一項**基建障礙**。」

Practice 68

> “Investment can reduce infrastructure barriers.”

「投資可以降低基建方面的障礙。」

Very relevant to your passage.

AI. ACCESS BARRIER

35. **access barrier = 使用 / 取得方面的障礙**

Practice 69

> “Distance can be an access barrier.”

「距離可以構成**使用 / 接觸方面的障礙**。」

Practice 70

> “Online services reduce some access barriers.”

「網上服務可以減少某些使用門檻。」

AJ. BARRIER TO ACCESS

36. **barrier to access = 取得 / 使用.....的障礙**

Practice 71

> “Cost is a barrier to access.”

「成本是取得服務的一項**障礙**。」

Practice 72

> “Limited parking creates a barrier to access.”

「泊車位有限會形成**使用上的障礙**。」

AK. EDUCATIONAL BARRIER

37. **educational barrier = 教育障礙**

Practice 73

> “Cost can be an educational barrier.”

「成本可以成為接受教育的**障礙**。」

Practice 74

> “Scholarships reduce financial barriers to education.”

「獎學金可以減少教育上的財務門檻。」

AL. HEALTHCARE BARRIER

38. **barrier to healthcare = 醫療服務使用障礙**

Practice 75

> “Transport can be a barrier to healthcare access.”

「交通問題可以成為獲取醫療服務的**障礙**。」

Practice 76

> “Language barriers may affect medical care.”

「語言障礙可能影響醫療服務。」

AM. BIOLOGICAL BARRIER

39. **barrier = biological structure that blocks/separates substances — 生物屏障**

A major scientific/medical branch.

Practice 77

> “The skin acts as a protective **barrier**.”

「皮膚是一道保護性的**屏障**。」

Practice 78

> “The barrier prevents harmful substances from entering.”

「這道屏障可以防止有害物質進入。」

Here barrier is physical but biological rather than man-made.

AN. SKIN BARRIER

40. **skin barrier = 皮膚屏障**

Practice 79

> “Harsh chemicals can damage the skin barrier.”

「刺激性化學物質可能破壞**皮膚屏障**。」

Practice 80

> “The skin barrier helps prevent water loss.”

「皮膚屏障有助防止水分流失。」

AO. BLOOD-BRAIN BARRIER

41. **blood-brain barrier = 血腦屏障**

A major biomedical term.

Practice 81

> “Some drugs cannot easily cross the blood-brain barrier.”

「某些藥物不容易穿過**血腦屏障**。」

Practice 82

> “The blood-brain barrier protects brain tissue.”

「血腦屏障有助保護腦組織。」

This is a genuine specialist compound and very common.

AP. PLACENTAL BARRIER

42. **placental barrier = 胎盤屏障**

Practice 83

> “Not every substance is completely blocked by the placental barrier.”

「並非所有物質都會被**胎盤屏障**完全阻隔。」

Practice 84

> “The placenta regulates exchange between mother and fetus.”

「胎盤會調節母體與胎兒之間的物質交換。」

Specialist medical term.

AQ. CELL BARRIER / MEMBRANE BARRIER

43. **membrane barrier = 膜屏障**

Practice 85

> “The membrane acts as a selective barrier.”

「細胞膜是一道**選擇性屏障**。」

Practice 86

> “The barrier controls what can pass through.”

「這道屏障控制哪些物質可以通過。」

AR. BARRIER FUNCTION

44. **barrier function = 屏障功能**

Medical/biology/materials.

Practice 87

> “The skin’s barrier function may weaken.”

「皮膚的**屏障功能**可能減弱。」

Practice 88

> “The coating improves barrier function.”

「塗層改善了**阻隔功能**。」

AS. BARRIER CREAM

45. **barrier cream = 防護霜；隔離保護霜**

Practice 89

> “Workers used barrier cream to protect their skin.”

「工人使用**防護霜**保護皮膚。」

Practice 90

> “Barrier creams reduce contact with irritants.”

「防護霜可以減少皮膚接觸刺激物。」

AT. BARRIER METHOD — CONTRACEPTION

46. **barrier method = 屏障避孕法**

Medical/sexual-health term.

Practice 91

> “Condoms are a barrier method of contraception.”

「安全套屬於**屏障避孕法**。」

Practice 92

> “Barrier methods physically block sperm from reaching an egg.”

「屏障避孕法以物理方式阻止精子到達卵子。」

AU. NOISE BARRIER

47. **noise barrier = 隔音屏障；隔音牆**

Practice 93

> “A noise barrier was built beside the highway.”

「高速公路旁建了一道**隔音屏障 / 隔音牆**。」

Practice 94

> “The barrier reduces traffic noise.”

「這道隔音屏障可以降低交通噪音。」

AV. SOUND BARRIER

48. **sound barrier = 音障**

A major physics/aviation expression.

Practice 95

> “The aircraft broke the **sound barrier**.”

「飛機**突破音障**。」

Practice 96

> “Breaking the sound barrier means exceeding the speed of sound.”

「突破音障即是超越音速。」

This is lexicalized and not just an ordinary “obstacle”.

AW. THERMAL BARRIER

49. **thermal barrier = 隔熱層；熱屏障**

Practice 97

> “The material acts as a thermal barrier.”

「這種材料充當**隔熱屏障**。」

Practice 98

> “A thermal barrier reduces heat transfer.”

「熱屏障可以減少熱傳遞。」

AX. VAPOUR / VAPOR BARRIER

50. **vapour barrier = 防潮層；隔汽層**

Construction.

Practice 99

> “The wall includes a vapour barrier.”

「牆體內設有**防潮層 / 隔汽層**。」

Practice 100

> “The barrier limits moisture movement.”

「這層屏障限制水汽移動。」

AY. MOISTURE BARRIER

51. **moisture barrier = 防潮屏障**

Practice 101

> “Packaging needs a good moisture barrier.”

「包裝需要良好的**防潮性能 / 防潮屏障**。」

Practice 102

> “The coating provides a moisture barrier.”

「塗層提供防潮阻隔。」

AZ. FIRE BARRIER

52. **fire barrier = 防火屏障 ; 防火分隔**

Construction/safety.

Practice 103

> “The building contains fire barriers.”

「大樓設有**防火分隔 / 防火屏障**。」

Practice 104

> “A fire barrier slows the spread of fire.”

「防火屏障可以減慢火勢蔓延。」

BA. SECURITY BARRIER

53. **security barrier = 保安屏障 ; 保安閘欄**

Practice 105

> “Vehicles stopped at the security barrier.”

「車輛在**保安閘欄**前停下。」

Practice 106

> “The barrier controls access to the site.”

「這道保安屏障控制進入場地的人車。」

BB. PROTECTIVE BARRIER

54. **protective barrier = 保護屏障**

Practice 107

> “The coating forms a protective barrier.”

「塗層形成一道**保護屏障**。」

Practice 108

> “Gloves provide a barrier between skin and chemicals.”

「手套在皮膚與化學物質之間形成一道**保護層**。」

BC. BARRIER-FREE

55. **barrier-free = 無障礙的**

A major compound adjective.

Practice 109

> “The building has a barrier-free entrance.”

「大樓設有**無障礙入口**。」

Practice 110

> “The aim is to create a barrier-free environment.”

「目標是建立**無障礙環境**。」

Common in accessibility.

BD. BARRIER-FREE ACCESS

56. **barrier-free access = 無障礙通道 / 無障礙使用**

Practice 111

> “The station provides barrier-free access.”

「車站提供**無障礙通道**。」

Practice 112

> “Lifts improve barrier-free access.”

「升降機改善無障礙通行。」

BE. ACCESSIBILITY BARRIER

57. **accessibility barrier = 無障礙使用方面的障礙**

Practice 113

> “Steps can create accessibility barriers.”

「樓梯可能造成**無障礙使用上的障礙**。」

Practice 114

> “Good design removes accessibility barriers.”

「良好設計可以消除無障礙使用方面的障礙。」

BF. BARRIER VS OBSTACLE

58. **barrier vs obstacle**

barrier

= something that blocks access/progress, often structural or persistent.

obstacle

= anything standing in the way of a goal.

Example:

> lack of charging infrastructure = barrier

> one broken charger = obstacle

Not absolute, but useful.

Barrier often feels:

* broader

* more systemic

* more enduring

BG. BARRIER VS HURDLE

59. **barrier vs hurdle**

barrier

= may block progress seriously.

hurdle

= challenge that can potentially be cleared/overcome.

> regulatory barrier

> = institutional obstacle

> technical hurdle

> = difficult challenge to solve

Hurdle often sounds more temporary/solvable.

BH. BARRIER VS BLOCK

barrier

= noun obstacle, often structural.

block

= something preventing movement/action; also a verb.

A barrier can block something.

BI. BARRIER VS BLOCKAGE

barrier

= something obstructing access/progress.

blockage

= obstruction inside a passage/system.

> trade barrier

> blocked pipe / arterial blockage

Not interchangeable generally.

BJ. BARRIER VS BOUNDARY

60. **barrier vs boundary**

barrier

= prevents crossing/progress.

boundary

= marks the limit or edge of an area.

A fence can be both:

* boundary marker

* physical barrier

but conceptually different.

BK. BARRIER VS BORDER

border

= geographical/political dividing line or edge.

barrier

= something that physically/figuratively blocks passage.

A border may have barriers, but:

> border ≠ barrier.

BL. BARRIER VS WALL

wall

= physical structure.

barrier

= functional concept: anything that blocks.

A wall can be a barrier.

A language barrier is not a wall.

So **barrier** is broader.

BM. BARRIER VS FENCE

fence

= physical enclosing structure.

barrier

= any blocking structure/factor.

Every fence may function as a barrier, but barriers include:

- * concrete blocks
- * gates
- * abstract obstacles

BN. BARRIER VS LIMIT

limit

= maximum/minimum boundary.

barrier

= factor preventing progress.

Example:

> budget limit

> = maximum spending amount

> cost barrier

> = high cost discouraging participation

Related but different.

BO. BARRIER VS CONSTRAINT

61. **barrier vs constraint**

barrier

= blocks/prevents progress.

constraint

= restricts what can be done without necessarily preventing it.

Example:

> lack of charger = barrier

> limited parking space = constraint

A constraint narrows options; a barrier may stop action altogether.

BP. BARRIER VS RESTRICTION

restriction

= rule/condition limiting action.

barrier

= obstacle, which may be caused by a restriction.

> visa restriction → may create a travel barrier.

BQ. BARRIER VS DISADVANTAGE

disadvantage

= puts someone in a worse position.

barrier

= actively makes participation/progress difficult.

Not every disadvantage is a barrier.

BR. BARRIER VS PROBLEM

problem

= anything requiring solution.

barrier

= specifically a problem that blocks progress/access.

So:

> all barriers are problems in some sense

> but not all problems are barriers.

BS. BARRIER VS RISK

risk

= possibility of harm/loss.

barrier

= obstacle preventing action/progress.

Example:

- > battery degradation = risk
- > no place to charge = barrier

Very useful for your passage.

BT. BARRIER VS DETERRENT

62. **barrier vs deterrent**

barrier

= makes action difficult/impossible.

deterrent

= discourages someone from choosing an action.

Example:

- > no charger nearby = barrier
- > high charging fee = deterrent

A deterrent works psychologically/economically; barrier emphasizes impediment.

BU. BARRIER VS BOTTLENECK

barrier

= broad obstacle.

bottleneck

= specific narrow point limiting capacity/flow.

- > insufficient charging infrastructure = barrier
- > too few fast chargers at one interchange = bottleneck

BV. BARRIER VS FRICTION

You previously discussed **friction** under remove.

barrier

= meaningful obstacle.

friction

= smaller inconvenience/resistance that makes a process less smooth.

Rough scale:

> friction → barrier

not always, but useful.

BW. BARRIER VS THRESHOLD

threshold

= minimum point at which something begins/qualifies.

barrier

= obstacle.

Example:

> income threshold

> ≠ financial barrier

Though a high threshold can create a barrier.

BX. BARRIER TO ENTRY VS ENTRY REQUIREMENT

entry requirement

= condition that must be satisfied.

barrier to entry

= anything making entry difficult.

A requirement may be reasonable yet still constitute an economic barrier.

BY. BARRIER TO ENTRY VS COMPETITIVE ADVANTAGE

barrier to entry

= keeps new competitors out.

competitive advantage

= helps existing firm perform better.

A patent may sometimes contribute to both, but concepts differ.

BZ. TRADE BARRIER VS TARIFF

tariff

= tax on imports/exports.

trade barrier

= broader category.

Tariffs are one type of trade barrier.

Other trade barriers include:

- * quotas
- * licensing rules
- * standards
- * administrative requirements

CA. LANGUAGE BARRIER VS LANGUAGE DIFFERENCE

language difference

= people use different languages.

language barrier

= that difference actually prevents/complicates communication.

So the mere existence of different languages does not always create a barrier.

CB. PSYCHOLOGICAL BARRIER VS FEAR

fear

= emotion.

psychological barrier

= mental factor preventing action.

Fear can become a psychological barrier, but they are not identical.

CC. BARRIER — CONCRETE TO ABSTRACT SEMANTIC MAP

The core idea is:

> **something stands between you and where you want to go**

From that physical image:

concrete

> road barrier

social

> language barrier

economic

> cost barrier

business

> barrier to entry

technology

> charging barrier

medicine

> blood-brain barrier

materials

> moisture barrier

So most senses remain very coherent:

> ****a layer, structure, rule, condition, or factor that blocks passage, access, transfer, or progress.****

CD. BARRIER IN YOUR PASSAGE

The passage says:

> “battery charging remains the greatest practical barrier.”

This is stronger than simply:

> inconvenience

because ****barrier**** implies that charging difficulty can actually:

* stop people switching

* delay adoption

* make ownership impractical

* deter high-mileage users

The following sentence explains the barrier:

> “they may have nowhere reliable to charge their cars overnight.”

So the barrier is not primarily:

> battery chemistry

but:

> ****access to reliable, convenient charging infrastructure.****

CE. SOURCE-SPECIFIC SEMANTIC CHAIN

The paragraph develops:

- > no private garage
- > → unreliable charging access
- > → long waiting time
- > → uncertainty
- > → lost time/stress
- > → difficulty fitting charging into daily life
- > → **barrier to EV adoption**

So **barrier** here means:

- > **a practical condition preventing willingness from turning into actual adoption.**

That is an important nuance.

CF. BARRIER VS INCONVENIENCE — SOURCE-SPECIFIC

Your passage contains both ideas.

inconvenience

= something troublesome/annoying.

barrier

= something serious enough to prevent or significantly obstruct action.

So:

- > inconvenient charging
- > can become
- > a barrier to buying an EV.

Barrier is stronger.

CG. BARRIER VS CONDITION — SOURCE-SPECIFIC

Later:

> “convenience is not a luxury in modern transport; it is the condition on which adoption depends.”

barrier

= what blocks adoption.

condition

= what must be present for adoption.

They are conceptual opposites:

> no convenient charging → barrier

> convenient charging → enabling condition

Excellent passage-level contrast.

CH. BARRIER VS GAP

Later the passage says:

> “trust gap.”

barrier

= obstacle that prevents progress.

gap

= difference/deficiency/separation.

A trust gap can itself:

> become a barrier.

But:

> gap ≠ barrier.

CI. BARRIER-FREE — FIGURATIVE

63. **barrier-free = without obstacles to access/participation — 無障礙的**

Beyond physical accessibility, it can be figurative.

Practice 115

> “The service aims to provide barrier-free access to information.”

「這項服務旨在提供**無障礙資訊獲取**。」

Practice 116

> “A barrier-free process should be simple and accessible.”

「無障礙流程應該簡單而容易使用。」

Still, physical accessibility is the strongest established usage.

CJ. BARRIER IN SPORTS

64. **barrier = fence/obstruction on a course — 障礙欄**

In racing/equestrian contexts.

Practice 117

> “The horse cleared the barrier.”

「馬匹越過了**障礙欄**。」

Practice 118

> “Several barriers were placed along the course.”

「賽道上設置了幾個障礙欄。」

This is physical rather than a completely new core sense.

CK. BARRIER IN COMPUTING / SECURITY

65. **barrier = mechanism preventing unauthorized access/action — 防護屏障；阻隔機制**

Practice 119

> “Encryption creates a barrier to unauthorized access.”

「加密形成一道防止未經授權存取的**防護屏障**。」

Practice 120

> “Authentication acts as a security barrier.”

「身份驗證充當一道**安全屏障**。」

Still figurative/functional blocking.

CL. TECHNICAL COMPUTING “BARRIER” — SYNCHRONIZATION

66. **barrier = synchronization point where processes/threads wait — 屏障同步點**

Specialist computing sense.

Practice 121

> “All threads wait at the **barrier** before continuing.”

「所有執行緒都會在**屏障同步點**等待，然後再繼續。」

Practice 122

> “A barrier ensures that every worker reaches the same stage.”

「屏障同步機制確保所有工作執行緒都到達同一階段。」

This is a genuinely lexicalized technical sense, but lower priority for general learners.

CM. CHEMICAL / MATERIAL BARRIER

67. **barrier layer = 阻隔層；屏障層**

Practice 123

> “The package contains an oxygen barrier layer.”

「包裝含有一層**阻氧層**。」

Practice 124

> “The coating provides a barrier against corrosion.”

「塗層提供一層防止腐蝕的**屏障**。」

Common in materials engineering.

CN. BARRIER AGAINST

68. **barrier against + threat/substance = 防止.....的屏障**

Practice 125

> “The wall provides a barrier against flooding.”

「這道牆形成防止水浸的**屏障**。」

Practice 126

> “Skin forms a barrier against infection.”

「皮膚形成一道抵禦感染的**屏障**。」

Pattern:

> barrier **to** progress/access

> barrier **against** danger/entry

Important preposition distinction.

CO. BARRIER BETWEEN

69. **barrier between A and B = A 與 B 之間的屏障 / 隔閡**

Practice 127

> “The glass forms a barrier between passengers and the driver.”

「玻璃在乘客與司機之間形成一道**屏障**。」

Practice 128

> “Distrust created a barrier between the two teams.”

「不信任在兩個團隊之間造成了**隔閡**。」

CP. BARRIER OF

Less productive.

English generally prefers:

- * barrier to
- * barrier against
- * barrier between

rather than trying to use:

> barrier of

as a general pattern.

CQ. PRONUNCIATION

****barrier**** /'bæriə(r)/

Approximately:

> ****BA-ri-er****

Stress:

> ****BAR-****

Plural:

> barriers

Adjective compound:

> barrier-free

No major pronunciation shift in the family.

CR. FAMILY / COMPOUND SWEEP

Useful modern inventory includes:

- * **barrier — physical** = 屏障 / 障礙物
- * **road barrier** = 路障
- * **safety barrier** = 安全護欄
- * **crash barrier** = 防撞欄
- * **crowd barrier** = 人群隔離欄
- * **barrier — figurative** = 障礙 / 阻力
- * **barrier to + noun/-ing** =的障礙
- * **practical barrier** = 實際障礙
- * **financial barrier** = 財務障礙
- * **cost barrier** = 成本門檻
- * **social barrier** = 社會障礙 / 隔閡
- * **cultural barrier** = 文化障礙
- * **language barrier** = 語言障礙
- * **communication barrier** = 溝通障礙
- * **psychological barrier** = 心理障礙 / 心理阻力
- * **emotional barrier** = 情感隔閡
- * **trade barrier** = 貿易壁壘
- * **tariff barrier** = 關稅壁壘
- * **non-tariff barrier** = 非關稅壁壘
- * **barrier to entry** = 市場進入障礙
- * **barrier to exit** = 市場退出障礙
- * **regulatory barrier** = 監管障礙
- * **legal barrier** = 法律障礙
- * **administrative barrier** = 行政障礙
- * **technical barrier** = 技術障礙
- * **infrastructure barrier** = 基建障礙
- * **access barrier** = 使用 / 取得障礙
- * **skin barrier** = 皮膚屏障
- * **blood-brain barrier** = 血腦屏障
- * **barrier function** = 屏障功能
- * **barrier cream** = 防護霜
- * **barrier method** = 屏障避孕法
- * **noise barrier** = 隔音屏障
- * **sound barrier** = 音障
- * **thermal barrier** = 熱屏障
- * **vapour barrier** = 隔汽 / 防潮層

* **fire barrier** = 防火屏障
 * **security barrier** = 保安屏障
 * **barrier-free** = 無障礙的
 * **barrier-free access** = 無障礙通道
 * **computing barrier** = 屏障同步點
 * **barrier layer** = 阻隔層
 * **barrier against** = 防止.....的屏障
 * **barrier between** =之間的屏障 / 隔閡

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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barrier — physical	用來阻止人、車、物質等通過的實體阻隔物
barrier — figurative	令某事難以發生、進展或普及的因素
practical barrier	在日常執行、操作、時間、成本或設施方面造成的實際障礙
financial barrier	因金錢不足 / 成本過高而造成的參與或購買障礙
language barrier	因使用不同語言而妨礙有效溝通的障礙
psychological barrier	因恐懼、缺乏信心等心理因素而妨礙行動的阻力
trade barrier	限制跨境商品 / 服務交易的政策或措施
barrier to entry	令新競爭者難以進入某市場的因素
regulatory barrier	因監管規定 / 審批程序造成的障礙
technical barrier	因技術限制或未解決技術問題造成的障礙
skin barrier	皮膚防止水分流失及外來物質進入的保護層功能
blood-brain barrier	限制血液中物質自由進入腦組織的生理屏障
sound barrier	與接近 / 超越音速時的氣動效應相關的「音障」概念
barrier-free	不存在妨礙殘疾人士 / 其他使用者進入和使用的障礙
barrier — computing	讓多個執行緒 / 程序在同一同步點等待的機制

For your original sentence

> “Second, battery charging remains the greatest practical **barrier**.”

The exact meaning is:

barrier = 一個嚴重妨礙駕駛者實際轉用電動車的要素；這裡特別指可靠充電位置不足、充電時間長，以及充電難以融入繁忙日常生活等問題。

Natural translation:

> **「其次，充電問題仍然是電動車普及最大的實際障礙。」**

The highest-value contrasts are:

- > **physical barrier** → 實體屏障 / 障礙物
- > **practical barrier** → 實際障礙
- > **financial barrier** → 財務門檻
- > **language barrier** → 語言障礙
- > **psychological barrier** → 心理阻力
- > **trade barrier** → 貿易壁壘
- > **barrier to entry** → 市場進入壁壘
- > **blood-brain barrier** → 血腦屏障
- > **sound barrier** → 音障
- > **barrier-free** → 無障礙的
- > **barrier ≠ obstacle** → barrier 往往更結構性 / 持久；obstacle 更泛指擋路問題
- > **barrier ≠ hurdle** → barrier 可真正阻擋；hurdle 往往暗示可跨越的挑戰
- > **barrier ≠ constraint** → 阻擋進展 ≠ 限制選擇 / 能力
- > **barrier ≠ inconvenience** → 嚴重阻礙 ≠ 單純不方便
- > **barrier ≠ risk** → 阻礙行動的因素 ≠ 未來損失發生的可能性